

Waqf — Stopping & Starting

■ This is a study companion for your Tajweed course. Each bullet point is a key concept from the video lecture. Review these pointers before or after each lesson.

What is Waqf?

- Waqf (■■■■■) = pausing/stopping during recitation, cutting off voice and breath
- Ibtidaa (■■■■■■■■■■) = starting again after the stop
- Knowing WHERE to stop is crucial — wrong stops can change or destroy meaning
- Waqf is considered a science of its own in classical Islamic scholarship
- Ibn Al-Jazari: 'Knowing the stops is one of the greatest sciences of the Quran'

The 5 Types of Stops (Waqf)

- 1. LAAZIM (■■■) — Compulsory stop: meaning changes severely if you continue
The Meem symbol is written in the mushaf — you MUST stop here
- 2. MUTLAQ (■) — Good/preferred stop: meaning is complete, recommended to pause
- 3. JAA'IZ (■) — Permissible: both stopping and continuing are acceptable
- 4. MURAKHKHAS (■) — Permissible but continuing is preferred
- 5. LAA (■■■) — Forbidden stop: stopping here distorts or changes meaning
You must continue — if you run out of breath, go back and restart

How to Stop Correctly on a Word

- Rule 1: Remove the final vowel — it becomes sukoon at a stop
■■■■■ → nooh (remove tanween damma, end with sukoon on Ha)
- Rule 2: Tanween Fatha (■■■) → becomes a long Alif at a stop
■■■■■■■■■ → salaamaa (tanween fatha = long Alif when stopping)
- Rule 3: Ta Marbuta (■) → becomes Ha (■) or silent at a stop
■■■■■■■■■ → rahma or rahmah (the Ta becomes Ha or silent)
- Rule 4: Final Qalqalah letter → apply Qalqalah (medium or strong degree)

Starting Correctly After a Stop (Ibtidaa)

- The place you restart must not leave a wrong impression on its own
- WRONG START EXAMPLE: Starting at ■■■■■■ ■■■■■■ ■■■■■■ after stopping mid-sentence
If you stopped at ■■ — the listener hears: 'laa ilaaha illallah' (OK)
But if you stopped at ■■ and restart at ■■■■■■ — it sounds wrong out of context
- RULE: If you stopped at a bad place, go BACK to a meaningful starting point
- Generally start at: beginning of a verse, or after a natural pause/full stop
- Never start in the middle of a grammatical or meaning unit

Special Case: Hamzat al-Wasl (Connecting Hamza)

- When you start a word beginning with ■■■ ■■■ ■■■ (Hamzat al-Wasl), add a vowel
- Example: Starting on ■■■■■■■■ — say 'ismi' (with kasra at the start)
- Example: Starting on ■■■■■■■■ — say 'uduu' (with damma)
- Example: Starting on ■■■■■■■■■■ — say 'al-hamdu' (connecting Alif-Laam)
- When CONTINUING (not starting), the Hamzat al-Wasl is silent — skip it
- Example: ■■■■■■■■ ■■■■■■■■ (continuing) → bismillah, not bismi-allahi

Famous Waqf Rules in Al-Fatiha

- End of each verse → Natural, recommended stop
- ■■■■■■■■■■ (v3) → Good stop — complete attribute of Allah
- ■■■■■■■■■■ (v4) → Good stop — complete verse
- ■■■■■■■■■■■■ (v5) → Excellent stop — complete declaration
- ■■■■■■■■■■■■ (v7, first) → Permissible stop
- ■■■■■■■■■■■■ (v7, end) → Final verse stop + Aameen follows
- Do NOT stop between ■■■■■■ ■■■■■■■■■■■■ and ■■■■■■■■■■■■ ■■■■■■■■■■■■

Quick Reference — Waqf

- ■■■ (Meem) = MUST stop — compulsory
- ■ (Taa) = SHOULD stop — preferred
- ■ (Jeem) = CAN stop — permissible
- ■ (Zaa) = BETTER to continue — but stopping allowed
- ■■■ (Laa) = DO NOT stop — forbidden
- At a stop: final vowel drops, tanween fatha → alif, ta marbuta → ha/silent
- After bad stop: go BACK to last natural starting point